

BFS218

Racism and the Digital Age

Understanding Techno-Racism

A short, friendly map to your companion site:
what it is, where everything lives, and how to
use it across live and asynchronous weeks.

BFS218

BFS218 Synchronous Companion Site

This instructor-created site is the companion to our blended synchronous BFS218 course. Open it from Blackboard or use the public address in this guide.

Everything around your class, in one site

This is the companion site for the blended synchronous section of BFS218. Weeks 1 to 3, 5 to 10, and 12 meet live. Weeks 4 and 11 are independent asynchronous learning. Weeks 13 and 14 have no lecture; the usual class window becomes office hours for completion, feedback, questions, and course closure. Study Week runs Monday to Friday, October 26 to 30, with no class and no new module. Red marks due dates, navy marks live classes, amber marks asynchronous weeks, and blue-grey marks Study Week. Blackboard remains the official Seneca course platform for announcements, assignment submission, grades, discussions, course records, and required administrative functions.

What it is

- Your weekly learning pathway, in working order
- Every source, concept, and self-check in one spot
- Your before-and-after-class companion, beside Blackboard

What it is not

- Not a replacement for Blackboard
- Not where announcements, submissions, discussions, grades, or course records live
- Not a place that collects student submissions or stores grades

How to use this page, on every page

At the top of every page on the site sits a bar labelled How to use this page. Open it for step-by-step instructions written for that exact page: what to click, what saves on your device, what is never graded, and where to go next. Each panel also carries Watch the video tour, a short silent captioned tour that shows the page in motion. If a page ever feels unfamiliar, that bar is the fastest way to teach yourself.

PRIVACY, ACCESSIBILITY, AND COPYRIGHT

Use it alongside Blackboard

This site does not require an account, does not collect student submissions, does not store grades, and does not send personal student information to the instructor, Seneca, or any server. The optional first name, notes, and check answers stay in this browser only, and browser storage can be cleared at any time: treat everything you type on the site as temporary and download what you want to keep. External media players may be subject to the privacy practices of the host platform.

Course readings and media are linked for educational use. Copyright remains with the original creators and publishers. Students should access readings through the provided links, Seneca library access, or Blackboard where applicable. Students who experience barriers using the site should use Blackboard and contact the instructor so access can be supported.

START HERE

Open How This Site Works first

It is the first item in the course menu because it explains what this companion site does, what still belongs in Blackboard, what saves only in your browser, and how to clear saved work on a shared device.

After that short orientation, open Home for the weekly journey. The instructional manuals stay in Site Support whenever you need more detail.

The menu is the map

How This Site Works comes first, before Home, so students meet the site boundaries, privacy controls, accessibility supports, and reset option before beginning the course journey. The rest of the menu is grouped by the work students are trying to do. Home and Calendar orient the term; Weekly Experiences

and other immersive spaces hold the teaching environments; source tools support evidence work; assignment and career tools support application; and Site Support keeps the instructional manuals and Report a Problem control.

BFS218, navigation	
TOP OF THE MENU	
01 How This Site Works What the site is, what it is not, privacy, and the Clear my saved work control	02 Home The course as a journey: every week, its guiding question, and where you are
03 Calendar and Due Dates Every date on one page, the current on-site Coming up banner, and the 11:59 p.m. Eastern Time deadline rule	
LEARN EACH WEEK	
04 Weekly Experiences Review any teaching week: the interactive experience for Weeks 2 to 12	05 Course Pathways The weekly rhythm before, during, and after class
STUDY THE SOURCES	
06 Readings and Media Every assigned source, as a searchable card	07 Source Practice Turn any source into practice questions, with a lens
08 Compare Sources Hold up to three sources side by side, every idea attributed	09 Videos and Podcasts Scholar media, loaded only when you choose to play
10 Glossary Every key term, always cited to its reading	11 Concept Flashcards Flip cards for every week, never scored
DO THE WORK, AND MORE	
12 Starting Your Assignment All five assessments, what each asks, and the week-by-week due dates	13 Career Choices The whole course reframed through your own program
14 Course Website Instructions This guide, online and as a PDF, plus a Report a problem button that emails the instructor	

The course as a journey

Home shows the full course rhythm. Each week carries a short LIVE or ASYNC badge, and the legend explains the colours. Live weeks use the before-class and after-class rhythm. Asynchronous weeks replace the lecture with a clear independent purpose. Every live week has a visible recording space; the captioned recording appears there after it is processed and posted. The journey lays the course out week by week, each station carrying the week's title and its **guiding question**.

- 1 Click any week station to open that week's page.
- 2 Coming back later? The site reopens where you left off on this device. Treat that as a convenience, not storage: anything you want to keep, download it.

The screenshot shows the Seneca BFS218 Companion website. The header includes the Seneca Polytechnic logo, the course title 'BFS218 Companion', a search bar with 'Reading Lens', and navigation buttons for 'Listen' and 'Switch section'. The main content area features a sidebar with 'ORIENT' links: 'How This Site Works', 'Home' (selected), 'Course Pathways', and 'Calendar and Due Dates'. The main content area displays a 'COMING UP' section with 'Open calendar' and 'Live class (September 8): Week 1 live class Course orientation and shared start'. Below this, there is a 'Live class (September 14): Week 2 live class' section with 'Assignment' and 'Pause' buttons. A large image of a group of people is visible at the bottom of the main content area.

HOME · THE COURSE JOURNEY, EACH WEEK WITH ITS GUIDING QUESTION

See the course through your program

BFS218 asks how racism travels through technology, and that question lands differently depending on where you are headed. Right on Home you can reframe the whole course around your own program of study, so techno-racism shows up in the tools and systems your field builds and uses every day.

- 1 On Home, find the control that says **See this course through your program**. Pick your program from the dropdown of Seneca programs, grouped by area of study. You can also pick a whole area, or choose **Still exploring**.
- 2 You stay on Home. Nothing navigates away. A short **For your field** panel appears at the top, tying the whole course to your program.
- 3 Each week on the journey gains its own short **For your field** line, and the weeks that matter most to your field are marked **Key for your field**.
- 4 For the deeper write-up, open **Career Choices** from the menu. It gives you three clear sections: program context, how techno-racism connects to that field, and how to use the lens in course work.
- 5 A small chip at the top shows **Viewing as your program**, with a way to change it or turn it off during the current session.

A lens, not a different course

Every student reads the same readings and does the same assessments. The lens only changes how the course is framed for you, it never changes what is required. You can turn it off any time, and the chip at the top of the page is how you do it.

Anatomy of a week

Every week page begins with an always-visible explanation of how that week works. Live weeks include the class-recording space. Asynchronous weeks explain why there is no lecture and what the independent time is for. Work the remaining sections in order, top to bottom.

This week in 80 seconds. Most content weeks open with a short animated overview under the week title, made with NotebookLM from that week's readings and reviewed by your instructor. Captions available on the player. It is a fast on-ramp into the week, not a substitute for the readings.

Study Guide. Before the Knowledge Check, each teaching week carries a rehearsal space: a quick warm-up from earlier weeks, explain-it-back cards where you put each key concept in your own words and compare with the reading, and a question ladder that works the week's guiding questions from recall to application. Nothing is recorded or graded; your notes stay in your own browser.

Knowledge Check. Every content week closes with an optional, never scored self-check. Set A and Set B are multiple choice, this week's ideas plus a short review from earlier weeks; Set C is different where the week offers it, with short scenarios, matching, and a written reflection you compare against a model. After you answer, you can say how sure you were, and the summary shows not just what you got right but where a confident answer was actually wrong, the thing most worth fixing. Nothing is recorded; clear or change any answer and take another set fresh.

- 1 **Time budget**, under the title, roughly how the week's work divides up.
- 2 **Overview & How this week works**, read this first; it tells you what to do and in what order.
- 3 **Purpose & Outcomes**, what you should be able to do by the end. Test yourself against these sentences.
- 4 **Guiding Questions**, carry at least one with you into the readings.
- 5 **Key Concepts**, each explained and cited to that week's reading, so you always know where an idea comes from.
- 6 **Readings**, full citation and a button. Open access, Seneca Library, Read on Blackboard, or Revisit from an earlier week.
- 7 **The Experience**, an interactive chapter sequence embedded on the page. Enter it, make choices, inspect the evidence, and use the Arrow keys to move between chapters.
- 8 **The Activity**, press Start and follow the prompts. Practice, not assessment.
- 9 **Reflect**, a short prompt (one or two sentences) to close the week.
- 10 **You can now**, the week's closing checklist. Tick what you can genuinely do; anything left unticked shows exactly what to revisit. Reset any time.

Seneca POLYTECHNIC BFS218 Companion

Q Reading Lens

► Listen

Switch section

SYNCHRONOUS · LIVE ONLINE CLASSES

FALL 2026

ORIENT

How This Site Works

Home

Course Pathways

Calendar and Due Dates

WEEKLY JOURNEY Week 2

1 Introduction to the 8

See this course through your program: General stream / no program

COMING UP Open calendar

Live class (September 8): Week 1 live class Course orientation and shared start

Live class (September 14): Week 2 live class

Assignment Pause

Return to Previous Screen

Home

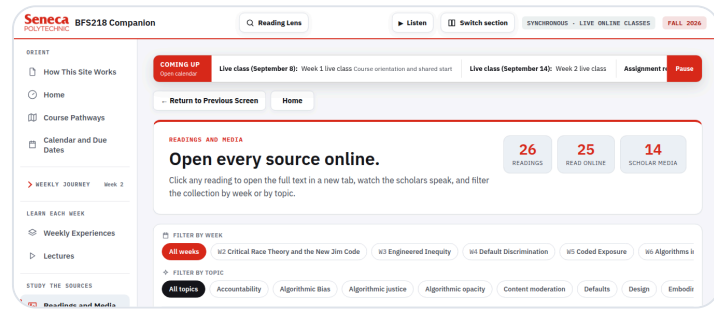


A WEEK PAGE · EVERYTHING IN WORKING ORDER, TOP TO BOTTOM

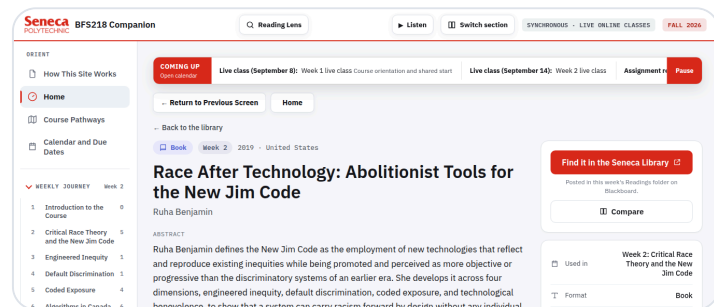
Every source, as a card

The library holds every course reading: what it is, what it argues, how long it takes, and how to reach it.

- 1 Search any author, title, or idea.
- 2 Filter to one week with the week strip, or browse by format.
- 3 Click a card for the reading's page: core idea, plain-language abstract, level and length, and where the text lives.
- 4 Press the red button to open the reading. A Source page button appears where a separate source or DOI exists.
- 5 Bookmark a reading to your Saved shelf. It stays on this device so you can return before an assessment.



EVERY SOURCE AS A CARD, SEARCHABLE BY WEEK

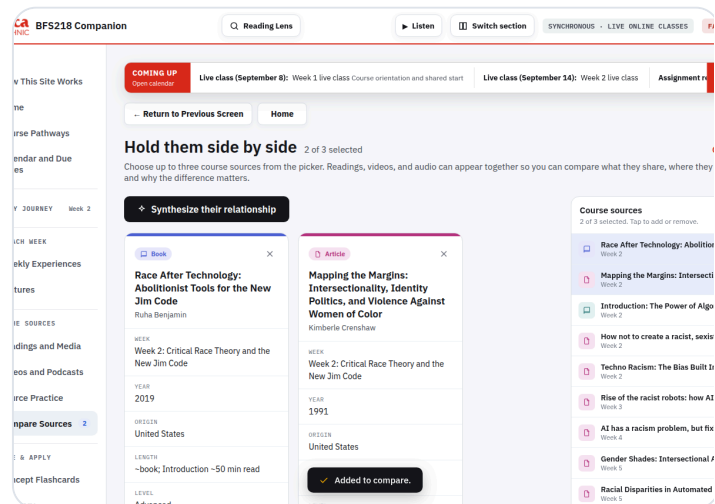


A READING PAGE • CORE IDEA, ABSTRACT, AND THE OPEN BUTTON

COMPARE SOURCES

Hold up to three sources side by side

- 1 Open Compare from the menu, or press Compare on any reading page.
- 2 Pick up to three readings. Each becomes a column: week, year, origin, length, level, and core idea.
- 3 With two or more selected, press **Synthesize their relationship**. The site explains how they speak to each other, every idea attributed.
- 4 With three, it takes the pairings one at a time, then asks what only appears when all three are on the table.
- 5 Remove a reading with the × on its column, or Clear all to start over.



EACH PAIRING EXPLAINED, EVERY IDEA ATTRIBUTED

Turn any source into practice

Choose a reading, choose a lens, and answer. Every answer comes back with a short explanation grounded in the reading itself, so a wrong answer still teaches you something specific.

LENS 01

Thematic

What it is about.

LENS 02

Argument

What it claims, and why.

LENS 03

Context

Where it sits in the field and the course.

GLOSSARY

Never defined out of thin air

- Browse by week (including the closing weeks) or search any term.
- Every definition carries a citation to that week's assigned reading.
- The *Scholars this week* strip introduces the people behind the readings. Click a name to jump to their reading.

CONCEPT FLASHCARDS

Practice, never scored

- Pick a week, or take all weeks together.
- Flip the cards: term on the front, definition and citation on the back.
- For question practice, each week page closes with its own Knowledge Check. Nothing is recorded; it exists so you know what to reread before it matters.



Weekly Experiences hub. The experiences for Weeks 2 to 12 all live in one place. Open Weekly Experiences from the menu and choose a week to re-enter it without hunting.

HANDS - ON

The studios & labs

Alongside the weekly activities, the site carries hands-on labs. Each one tells you what you are doing and why before you start. Nothing in them is graded.

Evidence Transfer Lab

Move a claim from source to argument, deliberately.

Accountability Chain Lab

Trace who answers for a harm, link by link.

Self-Check Studio

Package your studio work as a Word document to keep.

Browse it however you think

By week

Everything, week by week.

Tiles

The whole library as a wall you can scan.

Index

The alphabetical list.

WHEN BEGINNING FEELS DIFFICULT

Make a small, realistic start plan

Open **Starting Your Assignment**, then choose **Assignment Start Lab**. Choose the assignment and a realistic work-block length, then add as much personal context as helps: your preferred name, program or field, due date, next work session, exact sticking point, and work already completed.

What it creates.

Fixed course rules combine your answers into a personal starting point, course-specific next actions, a success target for the next work session, useful questions, and the right human support routes. The plan also explains why each pathway was selected. No AI is used.

What stays private.

Your name, context, answers, and plan stay in this browser on this device. Nothing is uploaded, submitted, graded, or sent to the instructor. Print or save the plan as a PDF, or copy it as text.

A PRIVATE PLAN · READY TO PRINT OR SAVE AS PDF

Choose the amount of support you need. For most BFS218 assignments, use the lab for a quick PDF plan or the Starter Studio for a more detailed Word preparation pack. For Compass Check, the lab creates readiness steps only. It does not generate, preview, or rehearse graded answers.

Blackboard remains official. Always return there for the complete brief, rubric, due date, submission link, and recorded grade. The lab helps you begin; it does not write the assignment or replace the instructor's requirements.

A rhythm that works

STEP 1

Open the week page early and read the overview.

STEP 2

Do the readings with one guiding question in hand.

STEP 3

Enter the experience and follow its chapters.

STEP 4

Do the activity.

STEP 5

Tick the You can now checklist honestly.

Before each assessment, use **Compare** on the readings you plan to write about, and run the **Knowledge Check** at the end of those weeks.

PRACTICAL NOTES

Good to know

- Works on phones, tablets, and laptops, and is designed for keyboard navigation.
- Clearing browser data clears them, and they do not follow you between devices.
- Your saved shelf, notes, and check answers live only in your own browser, on your own device.
- If the site looks stale after an announced update, refresh the page once.

THE ONE RULE THAT MATTERS

When in doubt, Blackboard wins.

BFS218 synchronous companion site. Blackboard remains the official course platform for submissions, grades, announcements, discussions, and course records.

Where to go for what

Start this week's work	Home ▶ click the week ▶ work top to bottom
Find a source fast	Readings and Media ▶ search or week strip
See how sources connect	Compare Sources ▶ pick up to three
Test yourself on a source	Source Practice ▶ pick a lens
Look up a term	Glossary ▶ search
Drill before an assessment	Concept Flashcards ▶ pick the weeks
Re-enter the week's experience	Weekly Experiences ▶ pick the week
Submit anything / check grades	Blackboard, always

Reading Lens and other study supports

The **Reading Lens** button at the top of every page opens reading supports that apply across the whole site: text size from 75 to 175 percent, comfortable spacing, a high-legibility font, nine page tints (including a blue light filter that warms the whole screen), a reading ruler that follows your pointer (choose its width, pin it in place, and drag it by hand), a large-print magnifier docked at the bottom of the screen, and read-aloud in your choice of the voices on your own device; a Listen button also sits at the top of every page. Inside an experience, use the separate **A minus**, **A plus**, and **Reset** controls to set experience text from 100 to 200 percent. Dense chapters scroll vertically at readable size instead of shrinking their text. Your choices save only in your browser, stay on until you change them, and a Reset all supports button returns everything to default.

Do not save your work on this site. Notes and check answers are never submitted, and never treat them as saved: they live only in this one browser and can be lost to a cleared cache, a different device, or a lab computer reset. Draft anything graded in your own documents, and at the end of any week download your notes with **Generate Your Weekly Notes**. On a shared or lab computer, the How This Site Works page has a one-click **Clear my saved work** control.

Week pages start folded. Each week opens as a clean map of headings. Press the button beside any heading to open just that section, up to two sections stay open at once (opening a third folds the earliest), and you can fold any section back down when you finish it. Sections fold again when you leave the week, so every visit starts from the clean map, and jumping to a section from the side list opens it for you.

Your study compass. The home page opens with a small panel that reads only what you have already done on this device (weeks opened, checks tried, reflections written) and offers up to three next steps. It uses a few fixed rules, not AI, and nothing about you leaves your browser. You can add your first name so the site greets you; the name stays in this browser only, is never sent anywhere, and Clear my saved work removes it along with everything else.

Coming up and phone access. The current schedule stays at the top while you move through the site. Pause freezes the message exactly where it is and keeps the text visible. The first visit in a browser also opens a short reminder. On a phone, Calendar and Due Dates offers a live calendar subscription. How This Site Works gives you the same site link to share or copy to another device. Blackboard remains the official source if a date changes.

Work inside every 3D activity. Each week uses the visual style that best fits its task: technical inspection, workshop, civic policy, or cartographic mapping. Drag to turn the scene, pinch or scroll to zoom, or use the view buttons. The default view shows the whole environment. Numbered explanations sit below the model so they do not block the evidence. Weeks with simulations let you change inputs, run repeated trials, and compare uncertain outcomes. A positive result can occur, but the underlying rules still shape which outcomes are more likely. The experience uses the same week model so the teaching and activity stay aligned.

If something breaks. Weekly Experiences open inside the site with the menu still beside you. If a model, recording, or video will not load, or anything looks wrong, use Report a problem on How This Site Works. It opens an email to the instructor with the page details filled in. No phone number is shown. If the site is unavailable, everything required for the course is also on Blackboard.

Privacy. Nothing on this site contacts an external service until you choose to load or play a video; when you do, YouTube's privacy-enhanced player applies its own practices inside its frame.

Experiments. Most weekly activities in BFS218 open with a short experiment: commit to a prediction, run it, read what actually happened, and see your own prediction mirrored back. The mirror names the thinking move you used, and across weeks it shows the pattern in your first instincts. It is never graded and never leaves your browser.